



Airco DH9A



DH89 Dragon Rapide 6



DH100 Vampire FB6



DH106 Comet 4C

1882 Geoffrey de Havilland is born in Hazlemere, Buckinghamshire.
1909 De Havilland designs, builds, and crashes his first airplane.
1910 In September, de Havilland completes a successful flight in his second airplane.
1911 De Havilland qualifies for the Royal Aero Club Certificate No. 4.
1912 De Havilland flies beyond 10,000 ft (3,000 m) in BE2 and breaks the British Altitude record.

1913 De Havilland is injured following a crash in a B.S. 1 scout.
1914 De Havilland joins Airco, following a period as Inspector of Aircraft for the Aeronautical Inspection Directorate.
1918 The Airco DH9A is launched.
1920 The de Havilland Aircraft Company is formed at Stag Lane.
1925 A prototype DH60 Gypsy Moth flies.
1931 A prototype DH82 Tiger Moth flies.
1933 Aircraft production begins moving to Hatfield.

1934 A DH88 Comet wins the MacRobertson England to Australia race and the DH89 Dragon Rapide enters service.
1940 A prototype DH98 Mosquito flies.
1943 John de Havilland is killed while flying a Mosquito.
1945 The RAF's second jet fighter, the DH100 Vampire, enters service.
1946 Geoffrey de Havilland Jr is killed while flying a DH108 Swallow.
1951 The world's first jetliner, the DH106 Comet 1, flies.

1952 A Comet is lost on takeoff, while a DH110 crashes at the Farnborough Air Show, killing 29 spectators.
1953 Two Comets crash.
1954 Two more Comets crash. The type is grounded, a significant flaw is discovered, and all are withdrawn from service and scrapped.
1960 The company is bought by Hawker-Siddeley, and products are rebranded "HS."
1965 Geoffrey de Havilland dies.

Sadly, one of de Havilland's sons died in one, while another was killed testing the transonic DH108 Swallow.

After World War II de Havilland continued to build both airframes and engines for both the civil and military markets, and also set up subsidiaries in Australia and Canada. Having produced the RAF's second jet fighter, the Vampire, it also commenced work on what would become the world's first jetliner, the Comet 1. Sadly, a series of well-publicized accidents

"It suddenly struck me that the name Moth was just right."

GEOFFREY DE HAVILLAND

revealed a fatal flaw, and the entire fleet of Comet 1s was grounded and scrapped after less than two years in service. An extensive redesign resulted in the Comet 4, but by then both Boeing and Douglas had brought jetliners to market that were vastly

superior. Unbowed, de Havilland also began work on a trijet, which would become the Trident. This time, political interference caused problems, when the original design was reduced in size to suit the requirements of a single airline, British European

Airways. Other airlines deemed it too small, and instead bought the larger Boeing 727. Ultimately, de Havilland only sold 117 Tridents, while Boeing sold more than ten times the number of its 727 aircraft.

Hawker-Siddeley bought de Havilland in 1960, although aircraft were still produced as "de Havillands" until 1963. Even today, the name lives on because literally hundreds of de Havilland and de Havilland Canada aircraft (predominantly Tiger Moths and Chipmunks) remain airworthy.

De Havilland Comet 3

The BOAC prototype de Havilland Comet 3 G-ANLO is displayed at the 1954 Society of British Aerospace Companies event in Farnborough.

